

MGS 616_HW3_Group13

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1. Split the data into training (60%), and validation (40%) datasets. Run a multiple linear regression with the outcome variable Price and predictor variables Age_08_04, KM, Fuel_Type, HP, Automatic, Doors, Quarterly_Tax, Mfr_Guarantee, Guarantee_Period, Airco, Automatic_airco, CD_Player, Powered_Windows, Sport_Model, and Tow_Bar.

Code:

```
# Select the columns for regression analysis
predictors = ['Age_08_04', 'KM', 'Fuel_Type', 'HP', 'Automatic', 'Doors', 'Quarterly_Tax',
              'Mfr_Guarantee', 'Guarantee_Period', 'Airco', 'Automatic_airco', 'CD_Player',
              'Powered_Windows', 'Sport_Model', 'Tow_Bar']
outcome = 'Price'
x = cars_df[predictors]
y = cars_df[outcome]

# Create dummy variables for the categorical column 'Fuel_Type'
x = pd.get_dummies(x, columns=['Fuel_Type'], drop_first=True)

# Split the data into training and validation sets (60% training, 40% validation)
x_train, x_valid, y_train, y_valid = train_test_split(x, y, test_size=0.4, random_state=42)

# Fit the regression model y on x
cars_lm = LinearRegression()
cars_lm.fit(x_train, y_train)

# Print the regression model coefficients
intercept = cars_lm.intercept_
coefficients = pd.DataFrame({'Predictor': x.columns, 'Coefficient': cars_lm.coef_})

# Display the intercept, coefficients
intercept, coefficients
```

Output:

(10139.352665041826,		
	Predictor	Coefficient
0	Age_08_04	-111.692000
1	KM	-0.017576
2	HP	29.732254
3	Automatic	535.405917
4	Doors	165.883438
5	Quarterly_Tax	16.944377
6	Mfr_Guarantee	156.521758
7	Guarantee_Period	73.685120
8	Airco	248.610630
9	Automatic_airco	3015.495036
10	CD_Player	304.590689
11	Powered_Windows	384.759273
12	Sport_Model	341.192746
13	Tow_Bar	-283.741189
14	Fuel_Type_Diesel	1785.071135
15	Fuel_Type_Petrol	1997.005756)

a) What appear to be the three or four most important car specifications for predicting the car's price?

Based on the coefficients from the model, the three or four most essential car specifications for predicting the car's price are:

- **Automatic_airco (Coefficient: 3015.50)** - This has the highest positive impact on the car's pricing, showing that vehicles with automatic air conditioning are worth much more.
- **Fuel_Type_Petrol (Coefficient: 1997.01)** - When compared to other fuel kinds, petrol adds a significant value to the car's pricing.
- **Fuel_Type_Diesel (Coefficient: 1785.07)** - The diesel fuel type has a significant positive impact on the car's price.
- **Automatic (Coefficient: 535.41)** - A car with an automatic transmission costs a lot more money.

In linear regression, a **negative coefficient** means that as the predictor increases, the car's price decreases

- **Age_08_04 (Coefficient: -111.69)**: As the car's age (months) increases, the price lowers. This is a common trend in the used car market, as older vehicles are typically less valuable owing to wear and tear, outdated features, and depreciation.

- **KM (Coefficient: -0.0176):** This shows that the price of the car drops as the mileage (kilometers driven) rises. A car with a higher mileage usually has more wear and tear on it, which lowers its resale value.

b) Using metrics you consider useful, assess the performance of the model in predicting prices.

Evaluation of Model Performance Using Various Metrics

After doing backward, forward, and stepwise feature selection, We used a subset of predictors to fit a multiple linear regression model.

A thorough evaluation of the model's ability to predict automobile prices using a variety of measures can be seen below.

Selected Predictors for the Model

The best subset of predictors, chosen through feature selection methods, includes:

Age_08_04, KM, Fuel_Type, HP, Automatic, Doors, Quarterly_Tax, Mfr_Guarantee, Guarantee_Period, Airco, Automatic_airco, CD_Player, Powered_Windows, Sport_Model, and Tow_Bar.

Backward Elimination

- In this case, backward elimination did not remove any predictors, implying that all variables contribute significantly to the model.

Forward Selection:

- This method starts with no predictors and adds them one at a time, selecting the ones that improve the model the most. It eventually arrived at the same set of 16 predictors as backward elimination.

Stepwise Selection:

- A combination of both forward selection and backward elimination. It started with an empty model and added/removes predictors iteratively. The best subset identified was the same as that found in forward selection.

All three methods consistently identified the same 16 predictors as the most relevant for predicting car pricing, giving high confidence in the regression model's feature selection. This selection process guaranteed that the model contained only features that contributed significantly to explaining the variation in car pricing.

The model's performance was first assessed using the training dataset. Here are the key metrics obtained:

Training Set Performance:

- **Mean Error (ME): -0.0000** – The average residual (difference between actual and predicted prices) is extremely close to zero, indicating that the model's predictions are unbiased on the training data.
- **Root Mean Squared Error (RMSE): 1202.30** – This metric indicates that, on average, the predicted car prices deviate from the actual prices by around 1202 units.
- **Mean Absolute Error (MAE): 912.35** – The average absolute difference between the predicted and actual car prices is about 912 units.
- **Mean Percentage Error (MPE): -1.07%** – This value indicates that, on average, the model slightly underestimates car prices in the training set.
- **Mean Absolute Percentage Error (MAPE): 9.06%** – The model's predictions are off by approximately 9.06% on average relative to the actual car prices, indicating a reasonably accurate model.

Model Performance on Validation Data

To evaluate how well the model generalizes to new data, it was tested on the validation dataset. The key metrics for the validation set are as follows:

Validation Set Performance:

- **Mean Error (ME): -116.82** – The model tends to slightly underestimate car prices on the validation set, with an average error of around -116.82 units. This suggests a small bias in the model.
- **Root Mean Squared Error (RMSE): 1221.04** – On the validation set, the model's predictions have an average deviation of approximately 1221 units from the actual prices, which is close to the RMSE on the training set, indicating good model generalization.
- **Mean Absolute Error (MAE): 890.80** – The average absolute difference between the predicted and actual prices in the validation set is around 891 units, similar to the training set's MAE.
- **Mean Percentage Error (MPE): -2.07%** – The model slightly underestimates car prices on the validation set by around 2% on average.
- **Mean Absolute Percentage Error (MAPE): 8.76%** – The model's predictions are off by approximately 8.76% relative to the actual prices on the validation set, indicating that the model maintains a good level of accuracy when predicting new data.

Screenshot of the output:

```
Intercept: 10139.352665041826
      Predictor Coefficient
0      Age_08_04 -111.692000
1           KM   -0.017576
2           HP    29.732254
3      Automatic 535.405917
4          Doors 165.883438
5   Quarterly_Tax  16.944377
6   Mfr_Guarantee 156.521758
7  Guarantee_Period  73.685120
8          Airco  248.610630
9  Automatic_airco 3015.495036
10         CD_Player  304.590689
11  Powered_Windows  384.759273
12        Sport_Model  341.192746
13         Tow_Bar -283.741189
14  Fuel_Type_Diesel 1785.071135
15  Fuel_Type_Petrol 1997.005756
```

Model performance on training data:

Regression statistics

```
                Mean Error (ME) : -0.0000
      Root Mean Squared Error (RMSE) : 1202.2957
        Mean Absolute Error (MAE) : 912.3493
        Mean Percentage Error (MPE) : -1.0741
Mean Absolute Percentage Error (MAPE) : 9.0636
```

Model performance on validation data:

Regression statistics

```
                Mean Error (ME) : -116.8193
      Root Mean Squared Error (RMSE) : 1221.0390
        Mean Absolute Error (MAE) : 890.7991
        Mean Percentage Error (MPE) : -2.0670
Mean Absolute Percentage Error (MAPE) : 8.7606
```